

Six update labels. Zero tracked changes.

The problem: an update label is not evidence that a useful detail changed.

My fix: compare the actual values in consecutive versions, not the source label. Below is a real browser run on a saved, sanitized government record. All six pairs were ignored because none of the six tracked fields changed.

7

notice versions

6

pairs compared

0

pairs with tracked changes

0

act or review decisions

The label would have over-alerted. The field comparison did not.

6 update-tagged pairs, but 0 changes in the tracked fields. Check any pair below for yourself.

2. Inspect a version pair

Every tracked field, including unchanged ones

1 · 070437-2026 → 070826-2026

2 · 070826-2026 → 071753-2026

3 · 071753-2026 → 072233-2026

4 · 072233-2026 → 073810-2026

5 · 073810-2026 → 074894-2026

6 · 074894-2026 → 076158-2026

Detail checked	Before 070437-2026	After 070826-2026	Finding
Status	active	active	Same
Closing date	2026-08-17T09:00:00+01:00	2026-08-17T09:00:00+01:00	Same
Contract value	41,666	41,666	Same
Currency	GBP	GBP	Same
Contract category	Not supplied	Not supplied	Same
Work packages	1: active	1: active	Same

3. Follow the decision

Source label: tenderUpdate

Act

Ignore ← this comparison

Review

No difference in the six tracked fields. Other parts of the notice may still have changed.

The actual comparison loop - extracted from the Python module used by the Run button:

```
changes = []
for path in MATERIAL_FIELDS:
    old_value = _get(previous, path)
    new_value = _get(current, path)
    if old_value != new_value:
        changes.append({"field": path, "old": old_value, "new": new_value})
return changes
```

Boundary: zero changes means zero differences in the declared fields, not identical documents. This selected example does not establish the rate of unnecessary updates across the source.

Missing information is not a safe answer.

The second problem: a real change can leave too little evidence to qualify the opportunity.

My fix: separate change detection from qualification. This cancellation has five tracked differences, but important qualification values are not supplied. The system sends it to **Review**, not a guessed approval.

2
notice versions

1
pairs compared

1
pairs with tracked changes

1
act or review decisions

Missing data is not the same as “nothing happened.”

The source calls this a cancellation. Five tracked fields differ, including absent values. The system keeps it visible in Review instead of filling in the blanks.

2. Inspect a version pair

Every tracked field, including unchanged ones

1 • 059143-2026 → 076161-2026

Detail checked	Before 059143-2026	After 076161-2026	Finding
Status	active	complete	Changed
Closing date	2026-07-07T12:00:00+01:00	Not supplied	Changed
Contract value	800,000	Not supplied	Changed
Currency	GBP	Not supplied	Changed
Contract category	Not supplied	Not supplied	Same
Work packages	1: active	1: complete	Changed

3. Follow the decision

Source label: tenderCancellation

Act

Ignore

Review ← this comparison

The category code is not supplied in this version. The value is not supplied in this version. The closing date is not supplied in this version.

What to inspect in the running demo

Orange rows show the exact before/after values. The source trail exposes the release IDs, capture time, source URL and saved-input hash. JSON and CSV downloads preserve the result of that run.

Two selected historical records from Find a Tender, captured 2026-09-03; Open Government Licence v3.0. A hash identifies the saved input; it does not independently authenticate the government source. Missing in a version does not prove a fact was removed from the original contract.

Do not take the screenshots on trust.

Run the same engine. Change a rule. Download the result. Run the checks.

Try to change the outcome. The deliberately invented example is worth 400,000 GBP. Its deadline extension stays the same; only the maximum-value rule changes. These are actual screenshots of two server executions, not designed result cards.

Maximum 5,000,000 GBP: ACT

2 notice versions	1 pairs compared	1 pairs with tracked changes	1 act or review decisions
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The changed opportunity fits these rules.

Synthetic scenario: value 400,000 GBP. Set maximum value to 300,000 or 500,000 and rerun. The input stays the same; the server recalculates the decision.

2. Inspect a version pair

Every tracked field, including unchanged ones

1 - qualified-1 → qualified-2

Detail checked	Before qualified-1	After qualified-2	Finding
Status	active	active	Same
Closing date	2026-09-18T12:00:00Z	2026-09-25T12:00:00Z	Changed
Contract value	400,000	400,000	Same
Currency	GBP	GBP	Same
Contract category	45000000	45000000	Same
Work packages	A: active	A: active	Same

3. Follow the decision

Source label: tenderUpdate

Act ← this comparison

Ignore

Review

The tracked change passes the configured category, value and date checks. This is not a guarantee of legal bid eligibility.

Maximum 300,000 GBP: IGNORE

2 notice versions	1 pairs compared	1 pairs with tracked changes	0 act or review decisions
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The changed opportunity does not fit these rules.

Synthetic scenario: value 400,000 GBP. Set maximum value to 300,000 or 500,000 and rerun. The input stays the same; the server recalculates the decision.

2. Inspect a version pair

Every tracked field, including unchanged ones

1 - qualified-1 → qualified-2

Detail checked	Before qualified-1	After qualified-2	Finding
Status	active	active	Same
Closing date	2026-09-18T12:00:00Z	2026-09-25T12:00:00Z	Changed
Contract value	400,000	400,000	Same
Currency	GBP	GBP	Same
Contract category	45000000	45000000	Same
Work packages	A: active	A: active	Same

3. Follow the decision

Source label: tenderUpdate

Act

Ignore ← this comparison

Review

The value exceeds your maximum.

Reproduce it in about a minute

1. Open the public demo using the link below. No login required.
2. Choose a historical record or the labeled synthetic example.
3. Click Run to execute the Python comparison engine.
4. Change a rule and rerun. Download JSON/CSV; compare input hashes.
5. Click Run automated checks to execute 14 core tests yourself.

Try it: contract-monitor-proof-lab.vercel.app

The repository also includes instructions for running the complete project locally.

22 full-suite tests pass; 14 core checks run on the public page. Tests cover real execution, repeatability, changed rules, missing data, exports and local access boundaries. Implementation and browser checks were performed by the same agent; this is not an independent audit.

Open code, data, tests and launch instructions on GitHub

Hosted replay of saved records, not a live data feed. No scheduling, source-wide coverage, customer savings or production readiness is claimed. The PDF is a tour; the executable project is the evidence.